authority declaring the disaster is supposed to make the request. In this case, your mother.

However, setting that aside, I'll have to point out the larger problem of available funds. This has been a year of disasters: 539 hurricanes as of May 4th and several more since, numerous floods, forest fires, drought in Texas and a number of earthquakes. What I'm getting at is that funds are dangerously low.

May I make a suggestion? This Administration, believing that government has done many things that could better be done by volunteers at the local level, has sponsored a Private Sector Initiatives Program, calling upon people to practice volunteerism in the solving of a number of local problems.

Your situation appears to be a natural. I'm sure your mother was fully justified in proclaiming your room a disaster. Therefore, you are in an excellent position to launch another volunteer program to go along with the more than 3000 already underway in our nation. Congratulations.

Give my best regards to your mother.

Sincerely,
Ronald Reagan

Another was from a minister who lived in a New York suburb who'd received a Republican senatorial fund-raising letter over my signature. A computer, for some reason, had seen fit to send the minister a letter that started, "Dear Mr. God."

"I've asked God for a great many things—particularly since getting this job—but never for a campaign contribution," I wrote to the minister. "Maybe I'll ask for help in correcting a greedy computer. At least the computer has raised its sights considerably; the only other experience of